MASTER PLAN

Lean Business Management Software

For an Architecture and Interior Design Studio: from first enquiry to a delighted client

A plan to run projects without daily chasing, link the design and site teams, measure performance fairly, reach 95%+ client satisfaction, and keep the whole system simple enough that the team enjoys using it every day.

Prepared for: Owner and Principal Architect, [Studio Name]

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Status: Updated master plan: adds organisation hierarchy, departments and approval authority to the priority, growth, Scaling Up, HR, attendance and turnkey plan

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1. Executive Summary

You are an architect and interior designer first. Yet your days go into daily huddles and personal follow-ups of tasks, so the hours that should go to design quality, client relationships and business growth are spent chasing people. Your team is not lazy; they simply have no clear daily direction, no personal stake in the outcome, and no fair way to see how they are doing.

This plan gives the studio a **lean operating system**: a small set of working habits, plus a **lean software** with only the features that earn their place. It does three jobs: it tells every person what to do each day and follows up automatically, it links the design team and the site team into one chain so projects finish on time and right, and it measures performance automatically so appraisals and incentives are fair.

> **The big idea:** manage by exception. Your team works from a simple daily list. The system chases, escalates and scores. You look at one screen that shows only what needs you, and spend your time on design, clients and growth.

The plan on one page

Problem today	Lean answer in this plan
You follow up tasks daily	Every person gets a "My Day" list of 3 to 5 priorities. The system reminds, then escalates step by step. You see an Exception View only.
No way to measure performance	Automatic scorecards with at most 4 metrics per role, feeding appraisals and an incentive pool. Shadow mode first, so trust is built before money is involved.
Design and site work in separate worlds	One chain: drawing released for site, site readiness check, site feedback back to design. Delays move dependent tasks automatically.
Delays, rework and drawing confusion	A drawing register with clear status, a question-and-answer flow between site and designer, and quality gates at critical stages.
Client happiness is a guess	Three simple rating points, a call within 24 hours for any low score, and a live Green/Amber/Red health score per project.
Tools get abandoned as too complex	About 14 screens, 3-tap actions, a 2-minute daily routine, mobile first, voice notes and photos instead of typing.
Risk of depending on a vendor	Full source code, data and all accounts in your studio's name. Settings editable by you without a developer.
Site staff cannot punch at the office machine	The eSSL machine stays. Staff also punch on the phone at the site, with location captured at that moment; late-mark rules are applied automatically.
HR is handled in registers and messages	A lean People module: employee file, leave, onboarding, appraisal link, training, and an attendance summary exported to payroll.
Turnkey projects of many types (civil, interior, renovation, commercial, factory)	One engine with five project templates. Project size decides which controls are switched on: cost, purchasing, contractors, site store, safety and cash flow.
Strategy lives in the owner's head; priorities shift every week; no studio-level view of cash	A Scaling Up layer: one-page Studio Plan, quarterly Rocks (company priorities), a fixed meeting rhythm with a Digital Huddle, accountability charts, client and staff voice, and a studio cash view (Section 5A).
Employees are unsure what to do first when tasks come from several people	Every task has a priority number. The person assigning chooses Do first, Today, This week or Later; the system turns it into the order 1 to 5 on My Day, shows what gets pushed down, and handles clashes without chasing (Section 5B).

Problem today	Lean answer in this plan
Worry that the software will be outgrown as the studio multiplies	Growth headroom is designed in: branches, teams, services and entities are added in Settings, with load targets for 1,000+ users and a no-code growth drill the vendor must pass (Section 14). Very large growth still depends on the business; the software must never be the limit.
Reporting lines, departments, approvals and who sees what are not defined	One organisation tree from owner to junior, six departments with their functions, two reporting lines (line manager and project captain), an approval matrix with limits, and visibility rules by level (Section 5C).

Where growth comes from (without adding headcount)

Growth in a design studio is limited by how many projects the team can run well at once, and by how many good enquiries turn into signed projects. The software lifts both. The multipliers below are directional targets to aim for, not guarantees.

Lever	How the software helps	Direction
More qualified enquiries	Every enquiry is tracked and followed up within the day; the best sources are visible	Up to 2x to 3x signed leads over time
Higher conversion	Fast, professional proposals; no enquiry left without a next action	About 1.5x
More projects per project captain	Standard templates, auto-follow-ups, fewer surprises on site	About 2x
Better margin and cash	Revision control, approved changes, stage-wise collection	Margin protected; faster collections
Referrals and repeat work	Happy clients are asked at the right moment	Growing share of new business

Reaching a very large multiple of today's revenue is a multi-year journey. The realistic aim for the first 12 to 18 months is 3x to 4x capacity with the same core team, while building the base for 10x over 3 to 5 years.

Software headroom: the software cannot create 100x growth by itself, because that also needs people, new services, cities, brand and cash. What it can do is make sure it is never the limit: the same system, without a rebuild, should serve a studio 100 times larger. Section 14 sets the tests for this.

2. Your Must-Haves and Where They Are Answered

Your requirement	How this plan answers it	Section
Stop daily follow-ups by the owner	My Day, automatic reminders, escalation ladder, Exception View, one weekly review	5, 6, 12
Team should show ownership	One named owner per task and per project; self-set weekly dates; visible impact on colleagues	5, 10
Measure performance for appraisal and incentives	Role scorecards calculated automatically; incentive pool; shadow mode	10
Design and site tasks interlinked	Release gate, readiness gate, RFI flow, auto-rescheduling	7
On-time, excellent quality, 95%+ satisfaction	Quality gates, health score, rating points, recovery call	7, 11

Your requirement	How this plan answers it	Section
Simple and easy; team enthusiastic	Lean scope, about 14 screens, 3-tap rule, 2-minute routine, progress ring and streak	6, 12, Appendix C
Attractive UI with changeable colour themes	Light, Dark and 3 palettes plus your brand; theme tokens	13
Dynamic dashboard	Role-based dashboards, owner Exception View with drill-down	13
All code with you for future editing	Ownership clauses, your own accounts, open-source stack, editable rules, handover pack	14
Lean management and lean software	Small role set, few meetings, switch-on-only-what-is-needed modules	5, 6
Best HR management	Lean People module: employee file, leave, onboarding, appraisal, training, payroll export	8
Attendance: eSSL machine, site staff, location	Three sources, one record; phone punch with location at the moment of punching; late-mark rules automated	9, Appendix D
Turnkey: civil, interior, renovation, commercial, factory	Five project templates, size tiers and nine turnkey controls	4
Operations of the book Scaling Up (Verne Harnish): People, Strategy, Execution, Cash	Studio Plan and quarterly Rocks, Critical Number and scoreboard, Digital Huddle and fixed meeting agendas, accountability charts, core values, client and staff voice, studio cash view. Already-covered parts are mapped, not duplicated.	5, 5A, 8, 15
Every task given by the owner or a leader carries a priority number, so the employee knows what to do first	Priority levels chosen by the giver, numbered queue 1 to 5 on My Day, effect preview, one Do first at a time, clash button, protected promises	5B, 12
Software that keeps working as the studio grows many times over	Growth headroom: unlimited branches, teams, services and entities by settings; load targets; open interfaces; no-code growth drill	14
Proper hierarchy from top to bottom management, with the basic departments and their functions	Five levels, six departments, dual reporting, delegation rules, approval matrix with limits, visibility rules, department head dashboards	5C, 13

3. How an Architecture and Interior Project Actually Flows

The software must speak the language of your studio, not generic project management. Below is the standard project journey the system is built around. Each stage becomes a template of tasks, outputs and approvals that is created automatically when a project is won. You can edit the templates for different project types (apartment interiors, villa, commercial fit-out, architecture only).

Stage	What happens	Typical outputs	Gate / client approval
1. Enquiry and first meeting	Qualify budget, timeline, scope, decision-maker	Lead record, next action	None
2. Brief and site survey	Questionnaire on lifestyle, family, taste, Vastu and budget; site measurements, photos and video	Brief sheet, measured plan, reference images	Brief sign-off
3. Concept	Space planning options and moodboards	Concept layouts, moodboard	Layout approval

Stage	What happens	Typical outputs	Gate / client approval
4. Design development	3D views, material and finish selection, furniture, lighting, coordination of electrical, plumbing and air-conditioning	3D views, material board, lighting and point layouts	Design and material approval
5. Working drawings	Detailed drawings: flooring, ceiling, electrical points, plumbing, elevations, sections and carpentry/joinery shop drawings	Drawing set with register and revisions	Internal review, then client sign-off, then "Released for Site"
6. BOQ and vendor selection	Quantities, rates, vendor quotes, work orders	BOQ, approved vendors	Budget approval
7. Execution	Civil changes, electrical and plumbing, false ceiling, carpentry, flooring, paint, furnishing and decor with site supervision	Daily site updates, snag list, change orders	Quality gates; material sample approvals; change-order approvals
8. Handover	Final snag clearance, as-built drawings, warranties and care manual	Handover pack	Client completion sign-off
9. After handover	12-month service period, review request, referral request	Service tickets, review, referrals	None

For pure architecture projects, add stages in the template for authority drawings and approvals as applicable, and for coordination with structural and services consultants. The software handles any stage list through templates, so no coding is needed to add them.

Because the studio also takes civil, renovation, commercial and factory projects on a turnkey basis, Section 4 shows how the same engine handles every project type with the right amount of control.

4. Turnkey Projects: Civil, Interior, Renovation, Commercial and Factory

Taking a project on a turnkey basis means the studio is responsible for design, purchasing, construction and handover for an agreed price and date. The risks therefore move to you: cost overruns, contractor delays, safety, statutory approvals and cash flow. The software must give you and your project managers control of these risks, with very little extra work for the site team.

> **The lean rule for turnkey:** one common engine for every project. The project type chooses the template, and the project size chooses which controls are switched on. A small apartment interior never sees factory-level screens, and a factory project gets the full set of controls.

4.1 One engine, five project-type templates

Project type	What makes it different	Extra stages in the template	Extra controls switched on
Interior (turnkey)	Design-led, many trades working in a small space, short cycle, finishing quality decides client satisfaction	The stages in Section 3	Material sample approvals, carpentry and joinery tracking, snag list, change orders

Project type	What makes it different	Extra stages in the template	Extra controls switched on
Renovation	Unknown existing conditions, hidden defects, often occupied premises, many change requests	Detailed condition survey with photos, scope freeze after survey, demolition and structural check, phased work plan	Discovery-variation log (hidden problems found, priced and approved before work), higher contingency, dust and protection checklist, occupancy plan
Civil construction	Long cycle, structure, heavy labour and material, weather, many contractors	Site mobilisation, excavation and foundation, structure, masonry, plaster, services rough-in, finishing, external development	Site material store, contractor measurement and running bills, material test records (as applicable), pre-pour and pre-closure checklists, daily labour count, safety log, approvals tracker
Commercial (office, retail, hospitality)	Tenant fit-out, landlord and building approvals, fixed opening date, heavy electrical and air-conditioning work, night or restricted-hour work, brand standards	Landlord and building approvals, design to brand guidelines, long-lead orders, work permits, services coordination, testing and commissioning, handover and occupancy	Approvals tracker, long-lead item tracker tied to the opening date, access and work-permit log, services testing checklists, delay alert against opening date
Factory / industrial	Layout driven by the process, steel or concrete structure, utilities, equipment foundations, strict safety, phased handover and commissioning	Requirement and process layout, statutory approvals (as applicable), structural design and procurement, foundations, shed erection, utilities, equipment installation support, fire and safety systems, testing and commissioning	Long-lead equipment and structure tracker, safety plan and permit-to-work log, subcontractor package tracker, milestone billing, commissioning checklists, statutory approvals tracker

Approvals and statutory requirements vary by city, state and project. The template carries a checklist of the usual ones for each type, and you confirm the exact list with your consultants for each project.

4.2 Project size tiers: right team, right controls

Not every project needs a full project-management apparatus. The system assigns a tier when a project is created, and the tier decides the team set and the controls. You set the value thresholds for each tier in Settings.

Tier	Typical example	Team	Controls switched on
Tier 1: Small	Apartment interior, small renovation, small shop	Project Captain, designer(s), one site supervisor	Standard: My Day, drawing register, site updates, snags, change orders, client page
Tier 2: Medium	Villa interior, larger renovation, office fit-out	Project Captain, site engineer, supervisors	Standard plus budget against actual cost, purchase orders, contractor work orders
Tier 3: Large	Building construction, large commercial project, factory	Full-time Project Manager, site engineers, planning and billing engineer, store keeper, safety officer as needed	All turnkey controls in 4.3, weekly Project Pulse, risk register

4.3 The nine turnkey controls

Control	What the system does	What it protects
1. Contract and scope baseline	Stores the agreed scope, inclusions and exclusions, price, payment schedule and completion date when the project is created. Everything later is measured against it, and every change becomes a change order	Margin and disputes
2. Budget by cost code	The BOQ becomes the budget by trade or package. The screen shows Budget, Committed (orders and work orders), Actual (bills paid) and Forecast to complete. An alert appears if commitments in a package pass its budget	Cost overruns
3. Procurement	Quotation requests to several vendors with side-by-side comparison, purchase orders with approval levels by value, and a long-lead tracker with order-by dates taken from the schedule	Price and delay risk
4. Contractors and work orders	One work order per package, measurement of completed work, running bills checked against measurement and agreed rates, retention tracked, contractor labour headcount recorded daily	Overpayment and disputes
5. Site store and materials	Material received (with a photo of the delivery challan), issued to work, and stock balance. Alerts for low stock and abnormal use	Wastage and pilferage
6. Progress measurement	Percentage complete is weighted by BOQ value, so a small task cannot distort the picture. Weekly progress against plan, with a simple progress curve	Schedule and billing
7. Billing and cash flow	Client bills from measured progress or milestones, payment reminders, vendor payment schedule, and a cash-in against cash-out forecast for each project	Cash, so you never fund a client's project by accident
8. Safety, quality and statutory	Daily or weekly safety checklist, incident log, toolbox-talk record, permit-to-work for risky jobs (as applicable), test records, statutory approvals tracker	People, quality and compliance
9. Documents and communication	Drawing register, requests for information, material approvals, site instructions and minutes of meetings, all against the project	Rework and blame games

4.4 The weekly Project Pulse

For every Tier 2 and Tier 3 project the system prepares a one-page Project Pulse each week, so the review takes 30 minutes and uses facts:

- Progress against plan, and the schedule variance in days
- Cost against budget, committed cost and forecast margin
- Cash position: bills raised, collected, due, and vendor payments coming
- Top three risks, with owner and action
- Client decisions and approvals waiting
- Safety and quality status

4.5 Risk register, contract types and closure

- **Simple risk register:** each project has its top 10 risks with an owner and an action. The template comes pre-filled by project type (for example hidden defects in renovation, equipment delivery delay in factories) and is reviewed weekly.
- **Contract types supported:** lump-sum (bills follow progress milestones), item-rate (bills follow re-measurement of quantities) and cost-plus with a cap (bills follow actual costs plus a fee). The billing screen adapts to the type chosen for the project.

- **Handover and defects period:** final snag list, as-built drawings, test certificates, operation and care manuals, warranty register, a defects-liability period tracker with service tickets, and the retention-release dates.
- **Closure review:** planned against actual cost, time and margin. The lessons update your rate library and templates, so each project makes the next quote more accurate.

> **If large civil, commercial or factory projects are already running:** bring the budget, contractor work-order and site-store controls (controls 2, 4 and 5) forward for those projects, so the biggest financial risks are covered first. The plan can be re-ordered; interior and renovation projects continue on the standard template.

5. Lean Management Model

Software cannot create ownership on its own. The studio needs a small, clear structure and very few meetings, supported by the system.

Roles (keep them few)

Role	Owns	Daily software time
Owner / Principal	Design vision, key client relationships, growth, final decisions	About 10 minutes: Exception View only
Design Lead (add when the team passes about 6 designers)	Quality of drawings and design output; internal review	About 15 minutes: review queue
Project Captain (one per project; a senior designer or architect)	Timeline, client communication, budget and handover of that project	About 20 minutes: team board and approvals
Designers / Architects / Draftspersons	Their design and drawing tasks on time and right first time	About 2 minutes plus work uploads
Site Supervisor / Engineer	Site tasks, quality gates, daily site update, snags	About 5 minutes on mobile
Sales / Client Relations	Enquiries, proposals, client touchpoints	Follow-up list and pipeline
Project Manager (turnkey projects, Tier 3)	Full control of a large civil, commercial or factory project: schedule, cost, contractors, safety and client	About 30 minutes: Project Pulse and approvals
Planning and Billing Engineer, Store Keeper, Safety Officer (large projects only)	Quantities and bills, site stock, safety compliance	Short daily entries on mobile
Accounts, HR and Admin (also the system administrator)	Billing, collections, people records, attendance approvals, templates and rules in Settings	As needed
Department Head (added as the studio grows)	Department scoreboard, the department team's growth and leave, approvals within limits, Rocks assigned to the department	About 15 minutes: department dashboard
Estimation, Procurement and Contracts team (quantity surveyor, purchase executive)	BOQ and rates, quotes, purchase and work orders, vendor and contractor records, checking of bills	Short daily entries, about 15 minutes

Meeting rhythm (daily huddle replaced by a Digital Huddle)

Rhythm	What	Duration
Daily	No standing huddle by default. The system sends a Digital Huddle each morning (wins, top priorities, items needing help, one number). People read My Day and do the 2-tap check-in in the evening. A 10-minute pod stand-up is an optional setting (Section 5A.3).	2 minutes per person
Weekly	Weekly Review run straight from the dashboard, with a fixed agenda: good news, Critical Number, Rocks, red projects and blocked items, client and staff voice, next 3 weeks	30 minutes, owner plus captains
Monthly	One-to-one using each person's scorecard: what went well, what to fix, what help is needed	15 minutes per person, by the captain
Quarterly	Planning day: review the quarter's Rocks, set the next 3 to 5, refresh the scoreboard; then appraisal and incentive review using the system's history	Half a day to one day
Annual	Two-day planning session: refresh the Studio Plan (values, 3 to 5 year target, brand promise, annual priorities) and set the year's budget and hiring	Two days, owner plus leads

Ownership rules

- **One owner per task, one captain per project.** Nothing is shared or unowned.
- **People set their own dates** each Monday. Dates people commit to themselves are kept far more often than dates imposed on them.
- **Every task has a priority number.** Leaders set the order, people set the dates. The employee never has to guess what comes first (Section 5B).
- **Show who is waiting.** A task shows the colleague who needs it next, which builds responsibility toward the team.
- **Decide once, in the system.** A decision made on WhatsApp but not recorded did not happen.
- **Escalation is a ladder, not a surprise:** person, then team lead or captain, then department head, then owner. You are only reached for real problems.

5A. The Scaling Up Layer: Strategy, Rhythm and Cash

Scaling Up by Verne Harnish organises a growing company around four decisions: **People, Strategy, Execution and Cash.** Its main tools are a one-page strategic plan, quarterly priorities called Rocks, a Critical Number, a daily, weekly, monthly, quarterly and annual meeting rhythm, accountability charts, regular customer and employee feedback, and the cash conversion cycle. This section shows what this plan already covered, what is added, and what is deliberately kept out so the software stays lean. The book's terms are used for reference; the screens use your studio's own words.

5A.1 What was already covered, and what is new

Decision	Already in this plan	Gap found	Added in this version
People	Role cards with four metrics, career ladder, onboarding, monthly one-to-one, scorecards, exit (Sections 8 and 10)	Core values not written or used; no single chart of who owns each function; no regular voice of staff	Core values on role cards, function accountability chart, quarterly Studio Pulse (5A.3, 5A.4)

Decision	Already in this plan	Gap found	Added in this version
Strategy	Growth levers in Section 1 and project templates	No written one-page plan, brand promise, target client or quarterly company priorities	Studio Plan screen and quarterly Rocks (5A.2)
Execution	My Day, escalation, Weekly Review, monthly one-to-one, quarterly review, Project Pulse (Sections 4, 5, 7)	Daily huddle was dropped; no company-level scoreboard or Critical Number; process owners not named; meeting agendas not fixed	Digital Huddle, scoreboard, process owners, generated agendas (5A.3)
Cash	Project budget, billing and cash flow (Section 4.3)	No studio-level view of how long money is tied up, collection days, payment days	Studio cash view and cash conversion cycle (5A.6)

> **Opinion in one line:** the plan already runs People and Execution well, project by project. What was missing is the studio-level layer on top: where the studio is heading this year and this quarter, and whether cash is healthy. It is added here as one screen and a few routines, not as a new heavy module.

5A.2 Studio Plan and quarterly Rocks (Strategy)

One screen, "Studio Plan", holds the studio's direction on a single page. The owner edits it; everyone can read it.

Element	What it holds	Where it shows
Core values and purpose	3 to 5 values in the studio's own words, and why the studio exists	Studio Plan, role cards, onboarding
3 to 5 year target	One bold, measurable target, for example revenue, signature projects or team size	Studio Plan
Brand promise and ideal client	What every client can count on (for example on-time handover, no hidden costs) and which clients and project types the studio serves best	Studio Plan; promise checked by client rating points
Annual priorities	3 to 5 priorities for this year	Studio Plan
Quarterly Rocks	3 to 5 company priorities for the quarter, each with one owner and a due date. Rocks are changes to the studio (for example starting a commercial fit-out service, or cutting drawing revisions by a third), not routine project work	Studio Plan, Owner view; tasks carry a small Rock label
Critical Number	The one number that matters most this quarter, for example collections, signed projects or stages delivered on time	Large tile on the Owner view

Link to daily work: a task can be tagged "supports Rock X". Staff see the label on My Day, which extends the existing "why it matters" field, and Rock progress rolls up automatically from linked tasks, so nobody reports it by hand. Tasks that support a Rock are lifted in the priority order (Section 5B).

Passes the five lean tests: the owner and leads use it weekly; it replaces the notebook, loose notes and repeated explanations; it is one page; it needs no training; and it shows the owner less, not more.

5A.3 Rhythm and accountability (Execution)

The daily huddle. Scaling Up treats a short daily stand-up (good news, today's priorities, stuck items) as a core habit. Version 1.1 dropped the huddle because your aim is to end daily chasing. The recommendation is to keep that decision but keep the huddle's value:

- **Digital Huddle (default):** a morning message with yesterday's wins, each person's top priorities, items needing help and one number of the day. It counts within the 3-notification limit.
- **Optional 10-minute stand-up:** a setting per team (Off, 2 days a week, Daily). Suggested default: Off for design pods; for site teams the existing toolbox talk can double as the huddle.

Weekly Review agenda (30 minutes, generated by the software):

- Good news and wins
- Critical Number and team numbers
- Rocks: on track or off track
- Red projects and blocked items
- Client voice and staff pulse
- Decisions needed from the owner
- One headline everyone should hear this week

Quarterly and annual: the quarterly planning day reviews the Rocks, sets the next 3 to 5, refreshes the scoreboard and runs the appraisal review. The annual two-day session refreshes the Studio Plan. The software prepares the data for each meeting, so no one builds slides.

Scoreboard. Each function has an owner and 3 to 5 weekly numbers that come from the system, so nobody types them. Examples: Sales (enquiries answered within 30 minutes, proposals sent, value signed); Design (stages on time, revisions per drawing set); Site (milestones on time, open snags); Accounts (invoices raised, days to collect); HR (attendance exceptions, open vacancies). These are team numbers and are separate from the four personal scorecard metrics in Section 10.

Function accountability chart. One screen lists the studio's functions, grouped by department (Section 5C), with one named owner, a backup and the scoreboard numbers. A function without an owner shows as "No owner" in red.

Process owners. Each core process has one named owner and one measure: enquiry to proposal, design release, BOQ to purchase order, running bill to collection, handover, and after-handover service. The template stores the process owner. Any staff member can tap "slow or unclear" on a task; it reaches the process owner and is reviewed monthly, and fixes update the template.

5A.4 People additions

- **Core values:** written once on the Studio Plan, shown on role cards and used in hiring and the monthly one-to-one. They are discussed with examples and never scored, so the four-metric rule in Section 10 holds.
- **Studio Pulse:** a 3-question quarterly check (what should we start, stop and keep?). Replies are summarised without names for the Weekly Review, which complements the confidential channel in Section 8.
- **Right people, right roles:** already covered by role cards, scorecards and the career ladder. No new feature is needed.

5A.5 Client voice

- One extra tap at handover and at the 12-month check-in: "How likely are you to recommend us, 0 to 10?". The three rating points stay.
- A client voice summary (low scores, comments, themes) appears in the Weekly Review.
- Each quarter the system suggests 2 or 3 recent clients for a 15-minute call by the owner or a captain.

- Margin by client type and project type, taken from the closure review, so the "ideal client" choice in the Studio Plan rests on facts.

5A.6 Studio cash view (Cash)

Section 4.3 protects cash project by project. The studio also needs one view across all projects. It uses data already recorded in billing, vendor payments and progress, so no new entry is needed. Accounting and statutory work stay in your accounting tool.

Measure	What it shows	Direction
Days to invoice	Days from a milestone or measured progress to the invoice being raised	Falling
Days to collect	Days from invoice to payment received	Falling
Days to pay vendors	Days from vendor bill to payment, kept within agreed terms	Stable, on terms
Unbilled work	Work completed but not yet billed	Low
Advance cover	Client advances collected against costs already committed, for turnkey projects	At or above plan
Cash conversion cycle	One monthly number for how long money is tied up between spending and collecting	Shorter
13-week cash forecast	Expected cash in and out: project cash flows, payroll, rent and overheads (Phase 4)	Never negative

A price what-if panel (effect on profit of a 1% price rise, 1% lower cost or 1 day faster collection) is an optional Phase 4 item for the owner only.

5A.7 Roadmap and what stays out

- **Phase 1:** Studio Plan screen, Rocks, Critical Number, function accountability chart, Digital Huddle, generated Weekly Review agenda.
- **Phase 2:** process owners on templates, optional pod stand-up setting, quarterly Studio Pulse.
- **Phase 3:** studio cash view and cash conversion cycle; recommend score on handover.
- **Phase 4:** 13-week cash forecast, margin by client and project type, price what-if panel.

Deliberately kept out: a separate strategy-planning suite, scoring staff on values, public leaderboards, longer meetings, and deep market and competitor worksheets (do these on paper in the annual session until the Studio Plan has run for two quarters).

5B. Assigning Tasks and Priority Numbers

Tasks reach an employee from many people: the owner, captains, team leads, colleagues and the project templates. Without an order, each person must guess what comes first, and that guess is the main cause of confusion and chasing. The rule: **one ordered list per person, and the order is a number.** Leaders set the order; people set the dates.

5B.1 How priority works

- **Every task has a number.** My Day shows tasks numbered 1 to 5 in the order to do them. Number 1 is done first. Tasks beyond five wait in a "Next up" list, also in order, so nothing is hidden.

- **Assigning takes three required fields:** what, who and due date. Priority is a fourth choice with a default, so giving a task stays quick.
- **The giver chooses a level, the system sets the number.** Levels are Do first, Today, This week and Later. If the giver chooses nothing, Auto ranking decides (see 5B.3). The system places the task in the person's queue and renumbers the rest.
- **See the effect before sending.** The giver sees the person's current queue and load, and a preview such as "This becomes number 1 and moves Ceiling drawings, Villa A to number 3". One tap confirms.
- **Every number has a short reason,** for example "Client meeting tomorrow" or "Site is waiting". It is filled in automatically and can be edited.
- **Do first is limited.** Only the owner, captains and team leads can use it, and only one Do first at a time per person. A second one asks which task it replaces. Colleagues can request urgency but not set it.
- **The employee never has to referee.** If two tasks from different people both claim first place, the employee taps "Clash: help me choose". The givers or the captain are alerted at once and decide within an agreed time (for example 2 hours). The decision is logged.
- **Promises are protected.** When a leader pushes a task down, the employee sets one new date with one tap, and the delay is tagged "priority change" so it does not count against promises kept (Section 10).

5B.2 What each person does

Person	What they do with priorities
Employee	Reads the numbered list on My Day and starts at number 1; taps Done, Blocked, Need help or Clash. Does not reorder the list.
Team lead or Project Captain	Assigns tasks with a level; sees each person's queue and load on the Team board; drags to reorder; resolves clashes; watches for overload.
Owner	Assigns with Do first when needed; sees only unresolved clashes, overloaded people and the monthly Do first count per giver on the Exception View.
Colleague (peer request)	Asks for help with Today, This week or Later; the request shows who is waiting. The owner of the task or the captain decides the rank.

5B.3 Auto ranking rules

Tasks created by project templates arrive already ranked, so most tasks never need a human to rank them. The rules run in this order and can be edited by the Admin in Settings:

- **1. Do first** set by a leader.
- **2. Blocking others:** tasks that stop a colleague, the site or a client approval.
- **3. Critical path:** tasks on the critical path due within 2 days.
- **4. Supports a Rock:** tasks tagged to this quarter's Rocks (Section 5A).
- **5. Everything else** by due date, then by how long the task has waited.

> **Passes the five lean tests:** staff and leaders use it every day; it replaces "do this first" messages, "urgent" WhatsApp texts and follow-up calls; assigning takes three taps; it needs no training because it is just a numbered list; and the owner sees only clashes and overload, not every task.

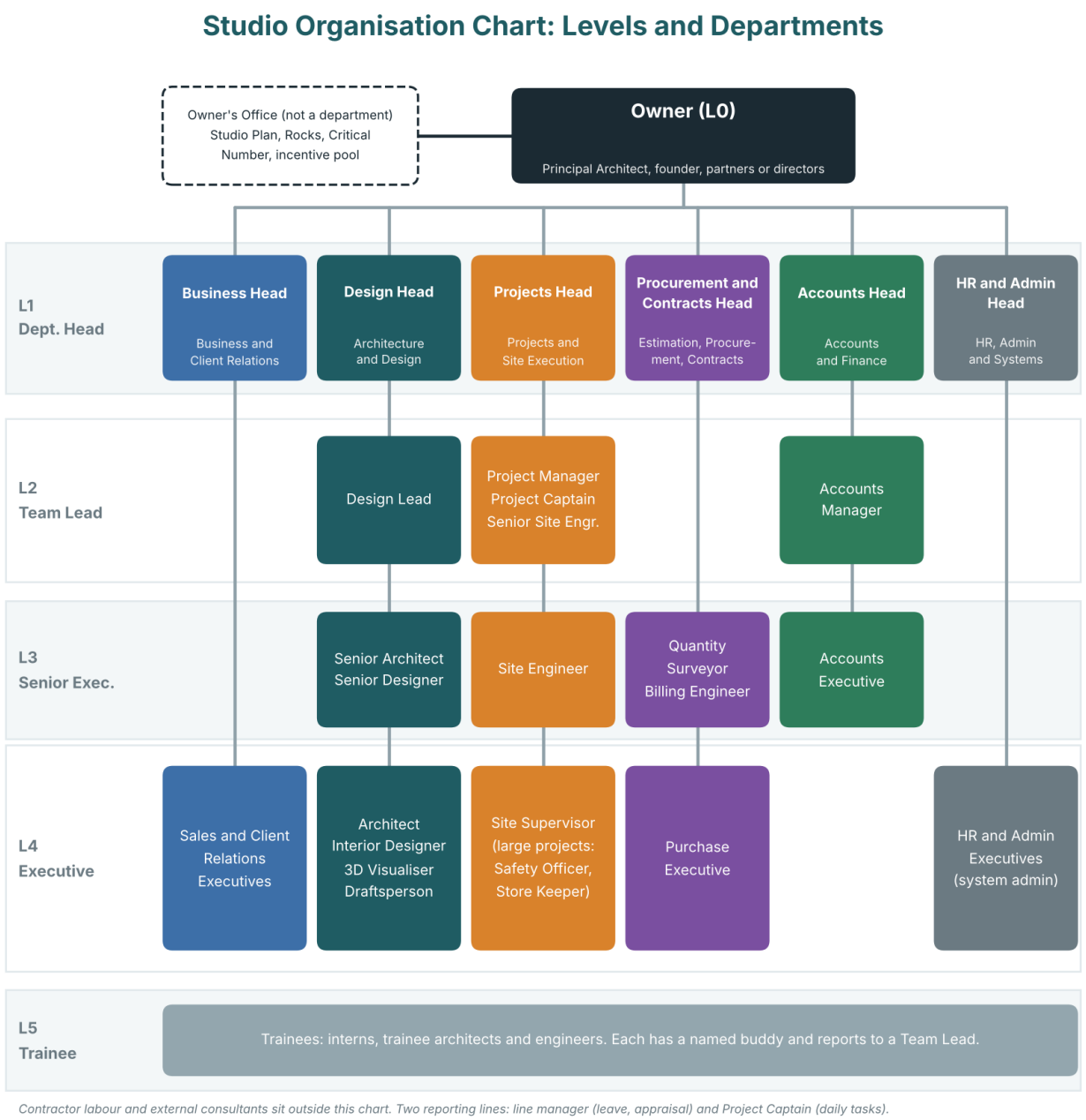
5C. Organisation, Departments and Authority

A growing studio needs a clear structure from the owner to the newest junior: who leads what, who reports to whom, who can assign work to whom, who approves what, and who sees what. This section defines it for an architecture, interior and turnkey studio. **Lean rule:** keep the structure as flat as the studio allows. Layers, departments and approval bands are switched on in Settings only when the size needs them, and never more than 4 levels separate the owner from a junior.

5C.1 Levels from top to bottom

Level	Typical positions	Decides and owns	Reports to
L0 Owner	Principal Architect, founder, partners or directors	Vision, Studio Plan and Rocks, key clients, final approvals, hiring of heads, incentive pool	Nobody
L1 Department Head	Design Head, Projects Head, Business Head, Procurement and Contracts Head, Accounts Head, HR and Admin Head	Department scoreboard, department Rocks, approvals within limits, growth of the department	Owner
L2 Team Lead	Design Lead, Project Manager, Project Captain, Senior Site Engineer, Accounts Manager	Runs a team or a project; assigns tasks with priority; approves leave and corrections for the team	Department Head
L3 Senior Executive	Senior Architect, Senior Designer, Site Engineer, Quantity Surveyor, Billing Engineer, Accounts Executive	Owns tasks and quality in their field; guides juniors	Team Lead
L4 Executive	Architect, Interior Designer, 3D Visualiser, Draftsperson, Site Supervisor, Purchase Executive, Sales and Client Relations Executive	Does the tasks on My Day; raises questions and snags	Team Lead
L5 Trainee	Intern, trainee architect, trainee engineer	Learns with a named buddy on a small project	Team Lead

Figure: Studio organisation chart (levels and departments)



Contractor labour and external consultants sit outside this chart. Two reporting lines: line manager (leave, appraisal) and Project Captain (daily tasks).

Workers employed by contractors sit outside this hierarchy and are tracked as daily headcount (Section 8.3). External consultants such as structural and services engineers are recorded as vendors with their own tasks and approvals, not as employees.

5C.2 Departments and their functions

Six departments cover the basic work of an architecture, interior and turnkey studio. The software gives each department its functions, its owner and 3 to 5 scoreboard numbers that come from the system.

Department	Functions the software supports	Team and head	Scoreboard numbers
Business and Client Relations	Enquiry pipeline, proposals and agreements, client onboarding, Client Page, ratings and recommend score, referrals, after-handover service tickets	Business Head with Sales and Client Relations executives	Enquiries answered in 30 minutes, proposals sent, conversion, value signed, average rating

Department	Functions the software supports	Team and head	Scoreboard numbers
Architecture and Design	Brief, concept, design development, working drawings, drawing register, internal review, release gate, answers to site questions, authority drawings, consultant coordination	Design Head or Principal Architect, Design Leads, architects, interior designers, 3D visualisers, draftspersons	Stages on time, first-time-right approvals, revisions per set, site questions answered on time, site-caused clashes
Projects and Site Execution	Schedule and look-ahead, site updates, quality gates, snags, change orders, progress measurement, handover; for large projects safety, site store, labour count and statutory approvals	Projects Head, Project Managers and Captains, site engineers, supervisors, safety officer, store keeper	Milestones on schedule, projects on time, snags at handover, rework, safety incidents
Estimation, Procurement and Contracts	BOQ and rate library, quote comparison, purchase orders, work orders, vendor and contractor records and rating, long-lead tracker, checking of running bills	Procurement and Contracts Head, quantity surveyor, purchase executive, billing engineer	Orders placed by order-by date, commitments against budget, vendor on-time delivery, bills checked on time
Accounts and Finance	GST invoices and client bills, collections follow-up, vendor payments, project cash flow, studio cash view, payroll input, link to the accounting tool	Accounts Head, accounts executives	Days to invoice, days to collect, overdue amount, vendor payments on terms
HR, Admin and Systems	People records, attendance and leave, onboarding, training, appraisal process, policies, claims, assets, office admin, system settings and templates	HR and Admin Head, executives; the system admin sits here	Attendance exceptions, open vacancies, onboarding on time, training done, staff pulse

Owner's Office is not a department: it holds the Studio Plan, Rocks, the Critical Number, incentive pool decisions and key client relationships.

Studio size	How the structure looks
Up to about 25 people	Owner, a Design Lead, Project Captains, one person covering Accounts, HR and Admin, one for Sales and Client Relations. Procurement is done by the Project Captain. Functions still have a named owner even when one person holds several.
25 to 100	Separate heads for Design, Projects, Business, Accounts, and HR and Admin; a small Estimation and Procurement team; Project Managers on Tier 3 projects.
100 and above	Branch heads with the same departments in each branch; shared services for Accounts, HR and Procurement; department heads at studio level; the Studio Plan and Rocks cascade from studio to branch to department (Section 14).

5C.3 Two reporting lines: line manager and project captain

In a design studio each person works for a department and also for projects. The software keeps the two lines separate so that nobody gets two conflicting bosses.

- **Line manager (one per person):** leave, attendance corrections, late-mark waivers, appraisal, growth, training and the monthly one-to-one.
- **Project Captain (one per project):** day-to-day tasks and their priority on that project, project approvals and the captain's input to the person's score.

- **Who can assign to whom:** the owner to anyone; a department head to anyone in the department; a team lead to the team; a Project Captain to anyone assigned to that project, from any department; everyone else makes a request. A request across departments goes to the other department's lead.
- **Priority and clashes:** the Project Captain ranks tasks within the project (Section 5B). A clash between two captains goes to the department head, and between department heads to the owner.
- **Escalation ladder:** person, then team lead or captain, then department head, then owner. A named deputy covers every approver on leave.

5C.4 Handoffs between departments

Section 7 links design and site. The same rule applies between all departments: every handoff is a task with an owner, a date and a visible dependency.

From to	What is handed over	What the system does
Business to Design	Won project, signed agreement, brief, budget	Creates the project and design tasks; sends the client welcome
Design to Procurement	Released drawings, material schedule, quantities	Release gate starts the BOQ and the long-lead list; order-by dates come from the schedule
Procurement to Projects	Purchase orders, delivery dates, approved vendors and contractors	Delivery dates feed site tasks; delay ripple alerts the people affected
Projects to Design	Site questions, measurements, drawing clashes	Questions become tasks with a deadline (Section 7)
Projects to Accounts	Measured progress, approved change orders, completed milestones	Drafts the client bill; reminds if a milestone is not invoiced within the set days
Accounts to Business and Projects	Collection status and overdue payments	Shows overdue on the project health colour; the owner decides on any hold
Projects to Client Care	Handover pack, snag closure, warranty dates	Opens the 12-month service channel, 30-day check-in, review and referral request
HR to all departments	Joining, onboarding, leave calendar, attendance summary	Runs the onboarding checklist; sends the monthly attendance summary

5C.5 Who approves what

Decision	Who approves	Notes
Leave, short permission, on-duty	Line manager	Balance visible; clash with a milestone is warned
Attendance correction, outside-zone punch, late-mark waiver	Line manager	HR sees every waiver (Section 9)
Do first priority and task reassignment	Owner, department heads, team leads, captains	Section 5B
Drawing release for site	Design Lead reviews, client signs, Project Captain releases	Section 7
Change order (extra cost or time)	Captain raises; Project Manager or department head up to [limit]; Owner above; client signs	Limit set in Settings

Decision	Who approves	Notes
Purchase order and work order	Procurement prepares; Project Manager up to [limit A]; department head up to [limit B]; Owner above	Value bands in Settings
Proposal fee below standard, or discount	Business Head up to [percentage]; Owner above	Logged with reason
Client bill before sending	Billing engineer prepares; Project Manager checks measurement; Accounts raises	Section 4.3
Vendor and contractor payment	Accounts prepares; Project Manager confirms work done; Accounts Head up to [limit]; Owner above	Value bands in Settings
Expense claims	Line manager, then Accounts	Phase 3
Hiring, promotion, appraisal outcome, incentive payout or adjustment	Department head recommends; HR processes; Owner decides	Adjustments logged with reason (Section 10)
Templates, scorecard weights and rules	Admin changes; weights and incentive rules need Owner approval	Every change logged

> **You set the limits:** the amounts in brackets are for you to decide and are edited in Settings. If an approver is on leave the request goes to the named deputy, and an approval waiting over 1 working day alerts and then moves up one level, so approvals never become a bottleneck.

5C.6 Who sees what

Person	Sees
Employee	Own tasks, score, attendance, leave and the projects they are assigned to; no cost, salary or incentive data of others
Team Lead or Project Captain	The team or project: tasks, workload, attendance today, approvals; budget and cost for Tier 2 and Tier 3 projects they manage
Department Head	Everything in the department, its scoreboard and projects; only the health colour of other departments' work
Procurement and Accounts	Orders, work orders, bills, collections and payments across projects; payroll summary but not appraisal data
HR	People records, attendance, leave, appraisal data, payroll summary; no project costs
Owner	Everything, with every override logged
Client	Their own project page only

Salary, incentive amounts and location data are visible only to the person, their line manager where needed, HR and the owner (Section 9.5). A designer never sees a purchase order, as set out in Section 6.

5C.7 How this appears in the software

- **Settings, Organisation tab:** departments, positions, reporting lines, deputies and approval limits. The admin edits it without a developer.
- **Org chart:** a tab in People, always generated from the records so it matches reality.
- **Department Head dashboard:** one screen with the scoreboard, Rocks, workload, clashes and approvals waiting (Section 13).

- **Scoring:** department heads are scored on their department's results (Section 10), and the function accountability chart in Section 5A uses these departments.

6. The Lean Software: Principles and Scope

Five lean tests every feature must pass

1. Does a specific person use it **every day or every week**? If not, it waits.
2. Does it **replace** something (a WhatsApp group, an Excel sheet, a follow-up call)? If it only adds, it waits.
3. Can it be done in **3 taps** or by voice or photo? If not, simplify it.
4. Can the person use it **without training**? If not, redesign it.
5. Does it help the owner **see less, not more**? Dashboards show exceptions, not every detail.

Nine modules, with the heavy ones switched on only when needed

Module	What it does	What it replaces
1. Leads and Proposals	Five-stage pipeline (New, Contacted, Site Visit, Proposal Sent, Won/Lost); template-based proposals with fee stages; alert if a lead has no action in 24 hours	Enquiries scattered over WhatsApp, calls and Excel
2. Projects and My Day	Project templates create tasks automatically; leaders assign tasks with a priority level; each person sees 3 to 5 tasks numbered in priority order; evening 2-tap check-in; reminders and escalation	Daily huddles and follow-up calls
3. Drawings and Approvals	Drawing register with status (Draft, Internal Review, For Client Approval, Released for Site, Superseded); revision history; one-tap client approval	Drawings floating in WhatsApp and email; confusion about the latest version
4. Site Updates and Snags	Daily site update with photos and three quick fields; questions from site to designer; snag list; quality gates; change orders	Site WhatsApp groups and verbal instructions
5. Client Page	Progress, photos, next decision needed, documents, approvals, one-tap rating	Client calls asking for updates
6. Scorecards and Dashboards	Automatic monthly scores; owner Exception View; manager team board	Manual appraisals and memory
7. People and Attendance	Employee records, attendance from the office machine and the phone (location only at punch), leave, onboarding, appraisal link, training, payroll export	Registers, Excel sheets, WhatsApp leave requests, manual late-mark counting
8. Turnkey Controls (switched on by project type and size)	Budget against actual cost, purchase orders, contractor work orders and bills, site stock, safety and statutory trackers, project cash flow	Excel cost sheets, paper registers and verbal commitments
9. Studio Plan and Rocks (Scaling Up layer)	One-page Studio Plan, quarterly Rocks linked to tasks, Critical Number and function scoreboard, accountability charts, Digital Huddle, generated weekly agenda, studio cash view	The owner's notebook, scattered goals and meeting notes, and separate Excel cash sheets

> **Lean rule for the heavy modules:** Turnkey Controls appear only on projects whose type and size need them, and People features appear only to the people who use them. A designer never sees a purchase order, and a small interior project never sees factory controls.

Deliberately left out (until the basics work)

Gantt charts, complex Kanban boards, public leaderboards, 360-degree appraisal tools, AI assistants, vendor portal, full payroll processing (we export to your payroll tool instead), continuous GPS tracking of staff, referral engines and festival-greeting automation. These are good ideas for later, but they would make the first version heavy. The only exceptions are items listed in the roadmap for later phases.

7. Linking the Design Team and the Site Team

Most delay and rework in design studios comes from the gap between the drawing board and the site. The software closes that gap with a simple chain of handoffs. Each handoff is a task with an owner, a date and a visible dependency.

Handoff	Design side	Site side	What the system does
A. Release gate	Drawing passes internal review and client sign-off; status becomes "Released for Site"	Site task for that work stays locked until release	Unlocks the site task and notifies the supervisor and the contractor
B. Site measurement check	Designer flags items that must be made to actual site dimensions (for example carpentry after plaster)	Supervisor uploads actual measurements with photos	Blocks fabrication until measurements are confirmed against the drawing
C. Readiness check	Material and sample approvals done by client	Supervisor confirms materials, labour and previous work are ready (short checklist)	Starts the stage; flags anything missing
D. Questions from site	Designer answers within the agreed time	Supervisor raises a question with a photo against a drawing	Creates a task for the designer with a deadline; logs the answer on the drawing
E. Site feedback to design	Fixes a drawing error and issues a new revision	Supervisor marks "drawing clash" on site	Counts the error for the designer's quality score; notifies affected tasks
F. Delay ripple	A design task slips by 2 days	Dependent site tasks, material orders and payment milestones	Shifts the dates automatically and alerts the right people

Quality gates at critical stages

At each gate the supervisor completes a short photo checklist before the next stage starts. The gate list is editable in Settings; suggested starting gates are:

- **Waterproofing:** completed, flood-tested, photos before covering
- **Electrical and plumbing:** conduiting and pipework done and tested before walls and ceilings are closed
- **False ceiling:** framework and services checked before boards are closed
- **Carpentry:** measurements matched to drawing; material and finish match the approved sample
- **Painting and flooring:** surface preparation checked before finish
- **Final finishing:** full walk-through before the client is invited

Weekly 3-week look-ahead

Every Friday the system lists, per project, the drawings, materials and client decisions needed in the next three weeks and who owns each. This single list prevents most last-minute firefighting.

8. People and HR Management

People are the studio's main asset, and good HR is what turns a talented group into a team with ownership. The lean approach: one home for each person's record, attendance, leave, growth and exit, with the routine work done by automatic rules, so HR is not a pile of registers and WhatsApp messages.

8.1 What the People module covers

Area	What it does	When
Employee file	Personal and job details, joining date, role, reporting manager, normal place of work, shift, documents (ID, appointment letter, certificates), emergency contact, and items issued (laptop, phone, helmet and safety gear)	Phase 1
Attendance and leave	See Section 9. Office machine, phone punch with location, late-mark rules, leave balances and approvals	Phase 1
Holidays and shifts	Holiday calendar, office shift, site shift, Sunday and holiday work rules	Phase 1
Onboarding	A 30-day checklist created automatically on joining (accounts, induction, policy reading, a buddy, first project, 30 / 60 / 90-day check-ins). This is just another project template, so it needs no extra machinery	Phase 2
Policies and acknowledgement	Attendance, leave, conduct and site-safety rules in one place; each person taps "Read and agreed", and the version they agreed to is recorded	Phase 2
Performance and appraisal	Monthly scorecard, 15-minute monthly one-to-one notes, quarterly review, 12-month history (Section 10)	Phase 1 (shadow) and Phase 3
Skills and training	A simple skills list per person (for example drawing software, site measurement, safety training), training plan, certificates, and skill gaps suggested from scorecard weak areas	Phase 3
Payroll input	Monthly summary of days present, half days, leave, on-duty, overtime or comp-off, late-mark deductions and incentives, exported to your payroll tool, Tally or Excel. Full payroll processing is not built, to stay lean	Basic export Phase 1, full Phase 3
Claims	Site travel and expense claims with a bill photo, manager approval and payment status	Phase 3
Feedback and concerns	A confidential way to speak to the owner or HR, and an optional two-tap weekly "How was your week?"	Phase 2
Exit	Checklist: handover of work (open tasks reassigned automatically), return of items, final settlement input, exit conversation	Phase 3
Core values and Studio Pulse	Core values appear on the role card and are discussed in the monthly one-to-one (they are not scored). Each quarter every person answers 3 questions (start, stop, keep); a summary without names goes to the Weekly Review	Phase 2

8.2 The employee journey

1. **Hire:** role card shows the purpose of the job, its four scorecard metrics and the growth path.
2. **Onboard:** the 30-day checklist runs itself, with a buddy and a first small project.
3. **Probation review:** based on real scorecard data, not impressions.
4. **Monthly one-to-one:** 15 minutes with the captain, using the scorecard.
5. **Quarterly appraisal and incentive review:** evidence from the system.
6. **Growth:** training plan and promotion along the career ladder.
7. **Exit:** an orderly checklist, and a conversation that teaches the studio something.

8.3 Best-practice principles built in

- **Clear role cards:** each role states what success looks like, in four metrics. People know the target before they are measured.
- **A visible career ladder:** for example Junior Designer, Designer, Senior Designer, Design Lead; and Site Supervisor, Site Engineer, Senior Site Engineer, Project Manager. Promotion criteria use scorecard history, which gives people a reason to care.
- **Fair and transparent:** rules are visible to everyone, and every approval or change is logged.
- **Recognition:** a weekly team shout-out, work anniversaries and skill badges.
- **Wellbeing:** the manager sees workload, leave balances and overtime, so site-crunch periods do not burn people out. Comp-off is tracked for Sunday and holiday site work.
- **Compliance stays organised:** statutory items such as provident fund, insurance and professional tax (as applicable) remain with your payroll tool or accountant. The software supplies clean attendance and leave data for them.
- **Contractor labour is not employee HR:** workers employed by contractors are tracked as a daily headcount per contractor under the turnkey controls, not as studio employees.

8.4 Leave and permissions

- **Leave types:** casual, sick, earned, comp-off, half day, short permission (in hours), on-duty for official visits, and loss of pay. Yearly credits, carry-forward and approvals are set in Settings.
- **Apply in 3 taps,** the manager approves in one tap, and the balance is always visible.
- **Team calendar:** captains see who is available before they plan, and the system warns if a leave clashes with a critical milestone.
- **Short permission in advance** (for example to leave early or arrive late for a genuine reason) is approved before the event and prevents a late mark.

9. Attendance: Office Machine, Phone Punch and Location

Your design team and your site team already use the eSSL machine, and the machine stays. The problem is that site engineers often go straight to site in the morning, or straight home from site, and then the machine cannot record them. This section gives one fair attendance system for office days, site days and visits, with location recorded whenever someone marks attendance away from the office.

9.1 Principles

- **One attendance record per person per day,** built automatically from three sources.
- **Fair to site staff:** working at a site counts exactly like working in the office, if it can be verified.

- **Location only at the moment of punching,** never continuous tracking.
- **Rules are settings,** not code: your grace time, late-mark count and deduction can change without a developer.
- **Exceptions only:** managers and the owner look at problems, not at every punch.

9.2 Three sources, one record

Source	Used when	What is captured	Checks
Office machine (eSSL biometric)	Office days for the design team and anyone in the office	Employee ID, date and time of each punch, imported automatically into the software	Matched to the employee by ID; duplicate punches merged; machine and software clocks compared
Phone punch (the app)	Site days, going straight to site, going home straight from site, client or vendor visits, travel	One-tap Punch In or Punch Out with server time, GPS location and accuracy, the name of the site or place, and an optional selfie for remote punches	Inside the assigned site zone is verified automatically; outside the zone needs a reason and manager approval; the phone's own clock is ignored
Correction request	Forgot to punch, machine fault, power cut, no phone signal	A short request within a set window (for example 48 hours) with a reason and any proof, such as site photos taken that day	Manager approves; corrections are counted and visible to HR

The day's status (Present, Late, Half day, Leave, On-duty, Site) is calculated from the first in-punch and the last out-punch from any source.

9.3 Your situations, solved

Situation	What the person does	What the system does
Site engineer goes straight to site in the morning	Opens the app at the site and taps Punch In	Location is inside the project's site zone, so it is verified. It counts as on time if done by the site shift start. The manager's board shows "At site: [project]". No trip to the office is needed.
Goes home directly from site	Taps Punch Out at the site before leaving	Verified at site; working hours are calculated from the first in to the last out
Forgot to punch out and went home	Gets a reminder next morning and raises a correction request	Suggests the time of the last site photo or daily update as supporting evidence; manager approves; it is not penalised without a chance to correct
Visits two or more sites in a day	Punches in at the first site, then taps Site Check-in at each next site	Check-ins show the day's route of sites visited (location only at those taps)
No signal at site	Taps Punch; the app stores it	Saved as an offline punch with its time, marked for the manager to confirm, and synced when the phone gets a signal
Client meeting or vendor visit	Marks On-duty with the place name	Location is captured; counts as present
Work from home (if your policy allows)	Applies in advance; punches from home	Counts against the monthly work-from-home limit; location is logged as home
Sunday or holiday site work	Punches as usual	Creates a comp-off or overtime entry for approval, as per your policy

9.4 Late marks and deductions (your current rule, built in)

- **Grace time:** 10 minutes after shift start. Later than that is a late mark.
- **Deduction rule:** three late marks in a month lead to a deduction of half a day's salary, as per your policy. The counter resets each month.
- **Visible counter:** every person sees "Late marks this month: 1 of 3" on their screen, with a gentle warning at 2. Most late marks are avoided simply because people can see them.
- **Site shift counts:** for a person assigned to a site that day, reporting at the site by the site start time is on time, wherever they came from.
- **Genuine reasons:** a manager can waive a late mark with a recorded reason (for example a site emergency, or early work the client asked for). Waivers are logged and visible to HR.
- **Minimum hours:** full-day and half-day hours are set in Settings. If hours fall short, the system marks a half day.
- **Month-end:** the deduction appears automatically in the payroll summary after the manager reviews it. Nobody counts late marks by hand.

> **Please note:** the software applies and records whatever policy you set. Confirm that your deduction rules are written in the appointment letters and policy documents your staff have acknowledged, and are consistent with the labour rules that apply to your studio, with your HR or legal adviser.

9.5 Location privacy and staff trust

Staff accept location marking when it is fair and limited. These rules protect trust and are also good practice under data-protection requirements:

- **Location is captured only when the person punches** in, out or checks in to a site. There is no tracking in between, after punch-out, or on leave.
- **Written notice and consent:** the attendance policy explains what is captured and why, and each person acknowledges it in the app.
- **Limited access:** the person, their manager, HR and the owner can see location data, and no one else.
- **Limited storage:** location data is kept for a defined period (for example 12 months) and then deleted or archived.
- **Selfie only for remote punches,** and stored briefly.
- **Purpose limited:** location is used for attendance and site verification only.

9.6 Light anti-cheating checks

- Server time is used, so changing the phone clock does nothing.
- Fake-location apps and developer-mode location are detected and flagged.
- One phone per person; a new phone needs approval.
- Poor GPS accuracy prompts a retry; a selfie is required for remote punches.
- The exceptions list shows unusual patterns (for example many outside-zone punches), so managers act on exceptions, not on every punch.

9.7 Who sees what

Person	Sees
Employee	Own month calendar (Present, Late, Half day, Leave, On-duty, Site), late-mark counter, leave balance, punch button, correction requests

Person	Sees
Project Captain / Manager	Today's board: who is in the office, at which site, on leave, or not yet punched; approvals for corrections, outside-zone punches, leave and waivers
HR	Monthly summary, exceptions, corrections, leave balances, payroll export
Owner	Exceptions only: repeated late marks, frequent corrections, unusual punch patterns

9.8 Linking your eSSL machine

eSSL machines can usually send their punch logs to a server over the network, through the maker's software or developer kit, or through exported log files. The exact method depends on your model, firmware and how the machine is connected. Phase 0 must therefore confirm the following before the build starts:

- The model number and firmware of your machine, and how it is connected (network or cable)
- Whether it can push logs automatically, or logs must be pulled or exported
- Who maintains the machine and the current attendance software, and the machine's clock accuracy

The preferred method is automatic sync every few minutes. The fallback is a scheduled file import. Each person uses the same employee ID on the machine and in the software, so the records match. The machine stays in your office and nothing there is replaced.

9.9 Month-end and payroll

1. The system prepares each person's summary: days present, half days, late marks and deductions, leave, on-duty days, comp-off or overtime.
2. The manager reviews exceptions and waivers.
3. HR approves.
4. The summary is exported to your payroll tool, Tally or Excel, and the month is locked.

10. Performance, Appraisal and Incentives

Every score is calculated automatically from work already recorded in the system, so nobody enters scores and nobody argues about opinions. The weights below are suggested starting points. Settle them with your team leads and keep them editable in Settings.

Role	Four metrics	Weight
Designer / Architect	On-time design stages First-time-right approvals (few revisions, few site questions caused by drawing errors) Client satisfaction on design Ownership (promises kept, responsiveness)	30% 30% 20% 20%
Site Supervisor / Engineer	Milestones on schedule Quality (gate passes, snags at handover, rework) Daily update discipline Client satisfaction on execution	30% 30% 15% 25%
Sales / Client Relations	Lead response time Conversion (meeting to proposal, proposal to win) Revenue closed against target Follow-up discipline	20% 30% 35% 15%

Role	Four metrics	Weight
Project Captain / Project Manager	Projects on time Margin against plan Client satisfaction (rating points) Collections on time	30% 30% 25% 15%

For turnkey projects, the Project Manager's margin metric includes cost variance against the budget, and the site team's quality metric includes safety compliance. The metric count stays at four.

Department Heads are scored on their department's results rather than on personal tasks. Suggested weights, editable in Settings: department scoreboard numbers on target 40%, Rocks owned 20%, team health (staff pulse, clash resolution, onboarding on time) 20%, and hand-offs to other departments kept on time 20%.

How the incentive works

- **Project incentive pool:** a fixed share of each project's gross margin (for example 3% to 5%, to be decided by you) goes into a pool for the team on that project.
- **Shares by role and score:** the pool is split by role weight and each person's score band (for example 90 and above gets the full share, 75 to 89 gets three quarters, 60 to 74 gets 40%, below 60 gets coaching and no incentive).
- **Two safety gates:** the pool pays out only if client satisfaction meets your threshold and the project margin is on plan. This protects both quality and profit.
- **Team win:** design and site share one pool per project, so they succeed together.
- **Live incentive meter:** each person sees their running score and what it would pay this month. No surprises.

Fairness rules

- Delays caused by the client, authorities or suppliers must be tagged with a reason and are **not counted** against a person. The exclusion is visible to everyone.
- Any manual adjustment by the owner is recorded with the reason in the audit log.
- No public ranking. People see their own score and the team average, not a leaderboard.
- **No double penalty:** punctuality and attendance are governed by the HR attendance policy (Section 9) and are not counted again in scorecards.
- **Priority changes are protected:** when a leader pushes a task down by placing something above it, the delay is tagged "priority change" and does not count against promises kept.
- **Values are discussed, not scored:** core values come up in the monthly one-to-one and the quarterly appraisal as a conversation with examples. The four-metric rule stays.
- **Shadow mode for the first 2 months:** scores and would-be incentives are shown but not paid, so errors are fixed and trust is built before money is involved.

Appraisal support

At appraisal time the system gives a 12-month history per person: score trend, strongest and weakest areas, client comments and key project contributions. This replaces opinion-based appraisals with evidence. More advanced tools such as 360-degree reviews are postponed until the basics run smoothly.

11. The 95%+ Client Satisfaction System

Client satisfaction is built through small promises kept all along the project, and by fixing problems early, not through a survey at the end.

Moment	What happens
Kickoff	Client receives a welcome message, team introductions, the timeline and a login to the Client Page
Every week	Auto-generated progress update with photos, percentage complete and what is coming next; the next decision needed is highlighted
Every approval	One tap to approve or request a change, time-stamped; revisions beyond those included prompt a paid change order
Three rating points	One-tap emoji rating after design approval, in the middle of execution and at handover (only three, to avoid survey fatigue)
Any score below 8 out of 10	The Project Captain is asked to call the client within 24 hours; a score of 6 or below alerts the owner
Handover	Structured walk-through, snag clearance with client sign-off, handover pack, completion certificate
After handover	A 30-day check-in, a 12-month service channel, and a polite review and referral request after a happy rating

Client voice (Scaling Up addition): the handover screen and the 12-month check-in carry one extra tap, "How likely are you to recommend us, 0 to 10?". The answers show as a trend by project type on the Owner view and as a summary in the Weekly Review. The three rating points stay as they are (see Section 5A.5).

Project Health Score (Green, Amber, Red)

Each project shows one colour. Suggested starting rules, which you can adjust in Settings:

- **Green:** on schedule, within budget, client approvals current, ratings 8 and above
- **Amber:** any critical task more than 2 days late, a client approval pending more than 5 days, or a rating of 7
- **Red:** more than 5 days behind, budget overrun above 10%, a rating below 7, or unresolved snags near handover

> **Target:** average client rating of 95% and above, with 100% of low scores followed up within 24 hours.

12. Screens and Daily Routines

The first release has about 14 screens in total, and each person sees only what their role needs.

#	Screen	Used by	Key content
1	Login and profile	Everyone	Phone or email login with OTP, theme picker
2	My Day	Staff	Top 3 to 5 tasks numbered 1 to 5 in priority order with a short reason, progress ring, Start / Done / Blocked / Need help / Clash, Monday week plan, evening 2-tap check-in

#	Screen	Used by	Key content
3	Task detail	Staff	What, why it matters, priority number and who set it, due date, who is waiting, files, voice note
4	Lead pipeline and lead detail	Sales	Five stages, next-action date, source, message history
5	Proposal builder	Sales	Template, fee stages, send link, opened or not
6	Project page	Captain and team	Timeline, tasks, drawings, people, health colour, approvals
7	Team board	Managers	Assign a task with a priority level; tasks by person in priority order (drag to reorder), overdue, blocked, clashes, workload
8	Owner Exception View	Owner	Red projects, blocked tasks, decisions waiting, low scores, revenue and pipeline
9	My Scorecard	Staff and managers	Score breakdown, trend, would-be incentive
10	Settings	Admin only	Tabs for Users, Organisation (departments, reporting lines, approval limits), Templates and Rules
11	Client project page	Client	Progress, photos, next decision, documents, one-tap approval and rating
12	My Attendance and Leave	Everyone	Punch In / Out button, month calendar, late-mark counter, leave balance, apply for leave, correction request
13	People (HR)	HR and Owner	Tabs for People, Org chart, Attendance exceptions, Leave, Payroll export
14	Studio Plan	Everyone views; Owner edits	Core values, 3 to 5 year target, brand promise, annual priorities, this quarter's Rocks with progress, Critical Number, who owns which function

A typical day for each person

Person	Morning	During the day	Evening
Designer	Punches at the office machine; opens My Day (30 seconds)	Works; uploads drawings; taps Done	Two taps: finished? blocked?
Site Supervisor	Taps Punch In at the site; opens My Day on the phone	Posts site photos, raises a question or snag by voice or photo	Daily site update, Punch Out at the site, two taps
Project Captain	Glances at the team board	Clears blocked items and approvals	Two taps
Sales	Opens follow-up list	Calls or messages; moves leads	Two taps
Owner	Opens Exception View (about 10 minutes)	Decides only on items shown	Nothing required

13. Look and Feel, Colour Themes and Dashboards

Because you are designers, the software must look good and feel calm. It should reflect the studio's own taste: clean, uncluttered, with generous space and clear type.

Design approach

- **Clean and visual:** large photos of the project, simple cards, plenty of white space, few colours at a time.
- **Friendly feedback:** progress rings that fill up, a simple on-time streak and a weekly team shout-out. No cluttered tables for staff.
- **Colour themes:** Light, Dark and three colour palettes, chosen by each user in their profile. Your logo and brand colours are applied across the app and Client Page.
- **Easy to extend:** all colours and fonts are stored as theme settings, so a new theme is added by editing one small configuration, not by redrawing screens.
- **Mobile first:** every screen is designed for a phone before a laptop.

Dashboards by role

Dashboard	Shows
Owner (Exception View)	Projects by health colour with reasons; tasks blocked over 24 hours; approvals waiting for you; low client scores; people missing commitments; month-to-date revenue and pipeline against target; next 90 days outlook; a top strip with this quarter's Rocks and the Critical Number. Everything drills down to the project or person; if all is well it says "All clear".
Project Captain	My projects and colours, overdue and blocked tasks by person, upcoming milestones, pending client approvals, workload balance
Department Head	The department's scoreboard numbers, Rocks owned, team workload and clashes, approvals waiting, attendance and leave issues, the department's projects by health colour
Designer	Today's priorities, stage deadlines, drawings awaiting review, feedback from site, my score and incentive meter
Site Supervisor	Today's site tasks, drawings released for me, material arriving, open snags, my score and incentive meter
Sales	Today's follow-ups, pipeline by stage, conversion, target against achieved
Client Page	Progress, latest photos, next decision, documents, payments (when billing is added), one-tap rating

Dashboards update live, can be filtered by date, exported to PDF or Excel, and a weekly summary can be sent to your WhatsApp or email.

14. Technology and Full Code Ownership

Lean technology choices

- **Common, open-source technology** that any competent developer in India can maintain, for example React or Next.js for the web, Node.js or Django for the server, PostgreSQL for data, and Flutter or React Native for Android and iOS.
- **Hosting in an Indian cloud region** such as AWS Mumbai, with encrypted data, role-based access, daily backups, two-factor login for admins and an audit log.
- **Buy the commodity parts, build the core:** use ready services for WhatsApp messaging, payments, e-signature and accounting links; build the workflow, My Day, drawing and site chain, scorecards and dashboards yourself, because that is your advantage.

- **Device and phone integrations:** the office eSSL attendance machine is linked to the software (Section 9), and the phone app uses GPS only at the moment of punching.
- **Rules in Settings, not in code:** project templates, reminder timings, escalation steps, quality gates, scorecard weights, health thresholds and attendance and leave rules are all editable by your Admin.

Making sure all the code is yours

- **Full ownership in writing:** all source code, designs, database structure and documentation belong to your studio on payment of each milestone.
- **Your own accounts:** code repository (GitHub or GitLab), cloud hosting, domain, app-store developer accounts and WhatsApp provider are registered in your studio's name. The vendor gets access, not ownership.
- **Code delivered every sprint** to your repository, not only at the end.
- **No lock-in:** no closed platforms or licences that stop you from editing or hosting elsewhere; every third-party component is listed with its licence.
- **Documentation pack:** architecture diagram, database design, setup guide, API guide and a short "how to change things" manual.
- **One-command setup and automated tests**, so a future developer can run and safely change the system.
- **Exit clause:** a knowledge-transfer period if the vendor relationship ends.

Handover checklist at the end of the project

1. Source code for web, mobile and server in your repository
2. Database design and a full data backup
3. All settings and credentials transferred securely to you
4. Deployment and server guide
5. Integration and API documentation
6. Admin and developer training sessions
7. Signed handover certificate

> **Optional low-risk step:** before investing in a full build, you can test the daily habits (My Day, evening check-in, weekly plan) for about 6 weeks using a simple shared task tool. Use it only to learn what your team likes. Do not let the trial tool become the permanent system.

Growth headroom: built to scale without a rebuild

The software should never be what limits the studio. Reaching 100x today's revenue is a long business journey that needs people, new services, new cities, brand and cash, and no software delivers it alone. The realistic aim stays 3x to 4x in 12 to 18 months and about 10x in 3 to 5 years. What the software must promise is **headroom**: the same system, without a rebuild, serves a studio 100 times larger by changing settings, not code.

Growth dimension	Requirement for the vendor	How you grow
People: 10 to 1,000+ users	Organisation tree of unlimited depth (branch, business unit, team); permissions follow the tree; roles are settings	Add users, teams and units in Settings
Projects: tens to 10,000+	Templates by project type and tier; closed projects archived but searchable; search stays fast	New project type means a new template, no code

Growth dimension	Requirement for the vendor	How you grow
Locations	Each branch has its own holidays, shifts, site zones, attendance devices and cost centre; the owner sees all branches in one view	Add a branch in Settings
Companies and billing	Several legal entities, GST registrations and numbering series; reports per entity and combined	Add an entity in Settings
New services	Landscape, services engineering, facade, product design or other lines with their own templates, scorecards and numbers	Copy and edit a template
Leadership layers	Dashboards per level: unit heads see their unit, the owner sees all units; the Studio Plan and Rocks cascade from studio to unit to team	Name unit heads in Settings
Language and labels	English, Hindi, Marathi and more; labels and units editable	Edit labels in Settings
Speed	Target: pages open in under 2 seconds with 1,000 users, 10,000 projects and 1 million tasks; photos stored as thumbnails; automatic cloud scaling; tested before each phase	Vendor shows load-test results
Integrations	Documented open API and webhooks for accounting, e-signature, payments, drawing files and marketing tools	Connect, do not rebuild
Cost	Monthly running cost estimated at 10, 100 and 1,000 users in the vendor quote; open-source stack with no per-user licence surprises	Predictable cost per user

Growth stages (guideposts, not forecasts): up to about 25 people, the plan as written with one office; 25 to 100, add Design Leads, Project Managers and unit heads and run reviews per unit; 100 to 500, add branches, entities, a larger HR and accounts team and regional site teams; beyond 500, shared service teams, an organisation-wide rate library and deeper integrations.

> **No-code growth drill:** before sign-off of each phase the vendor must, using Settings only, add a branch, a business unit, a service line with its own template, a new role with scorecard and a new entity, and show the system running with sample data at the load targets above. If any step needs a developer, it is a defect.

15. Roadmap

The roadmap puts the features that free your time first. Each phase ends with a working system used by a pilot team on live projects, and with the code delivered to you.

Phase	Timing	What is built	Result for you
0. Discovery and prototype	Weeks 1 to 4	Map your real process for each project type; confirm the eSSL machine model and connection; agree templates, scorecards, incentive and attendance rules; clickable prototype with themes; test it with your staff; agree the growth headroom tests (Section 14)	A blueprint and a prototype your team likes before any code is written

Phase	Timing	What is built	Result for you
1. Ownership Core	Months 2 to 5	Login and roles, employee records, My Day and task engine, interior and renovation templates, attendance (eSSL link, phone punch with location, late-mark rules, leave), reminders and escalation, leads and proposals, Owner Exception View, scorecards in shadow mode, themes, basic Client Page, Settings; Studio Plan screen with quarterly Rocks, Critical Number and function accountability chart; Digital Huddle and generated Weekly Review agenda; task assignment with priority numbers and clash alerts; organisation setup (departments, reporting lines, visibility rules)	Daily follow-ups and attendance chasing start to disappear
2. Design-Site Chain and Turnkey Controls	Months 6 to 8	Drawing register and release gate, site updates and snags (works offline), questions from site, quality gates, change orders, health score; civil, commercial and factory templates; budget against actual cost, purchase orders, contractor work orders, site store, safety log, approvals tracker; policies and onboarding; Hindi and Marathi labels; process owners on templates, optional pod stand-up setting, quarterly Studio Pulse; department head dashboards, approval limits for purchase orders, change orders and discounts, cross-department handoffs	Projects run on time and on budget with fewer surprises
3. Money, People and Incentives	Months 9 to 10	GST billing and running bills, vendor payments, project cash flow, incentive payouts go live, payroll export, claims, training and skills, exit checklist, rating points, full Client Page; studio cash view (days to invoice, days to collect, cash conversion cycle)	Cash discipline; fair incentives; complete HR
4. Intelligence	Months 11 to 12	Analytics and forecasts, referral tracking, optional AI helpers (status answers, proposal drafts); 13-week studio cash forecast, margin by client and project type, price what-if panel	Data-driven growth
5. Handover and improve	Month 12 onward	Final documents, training, handover certificate, continuous small improvements	Full independence

Pilot approach: before each phase goes to everyone, one design pod and one site team use it on 2 to 3 live projects for about 6 weeks.

Phase 1 build plan: eight two-week sprints

Sprint	Focus	Demo to your team
1	Login, roles, organisation tree (departments, reporting lines), theme system, users, employee records	Log in, switch themes, see role home pages and the org chart
2	Project templates (interior and renovation), task engine, assign a task with a priority level, numbered My Day (basic)	Create a project, assign a task as Do first and watch the numbers change
3	Attendance: eSSL log import, phone punch with location, site zones, leave	Punch at a site and see it on the manager board
4	Reminders, evening check-in, weekly plan, WhatsApp, Digital Huddle	Receive a morning message and check in
5	Lead pipeline, proposals, auto-create project	Mark a lead Won and see the project created

Sprint	Focus	Demo to your team
6	Owner Exception View, team board with drag-to-reorder queues and clash alerts, escalation, Studio Plan and Rocks	Watch a late task escalate and see this quarter's Rocks on the Owner view
7	Late-mark rules, month-end attendance summary, scorecards (shadow mode)	See a late-mark counter and a monthly summary
8	Basic Client Page, polish, pilot training	Pilot team starts on live projects

16. Budget Framework

Exact costs depend on the vendor quotes you receive. Use this structure to compare quotes and to keep spending lean. Obtain fixed prices through the development RFP, which is prepared as a separate document.

Budget head	Guidance
Discovery and prototype (Phase 0)	Pay a fixed fee. Treat the prototype as the most valuable early investment, because it prevents expensive mistakes
Phase 1 build	Fixed price, paid in milestones tied to accepted sprint demos and delivery of code to your repository
Phases 2 to 4	Price each phase separately; commit to the next phase only after the pilot of the previous one succeeds
Running costs	Hosting, WhatsApp messaging, SMS, e-signature and payment-gateway charges: ask for a monthly estimate and who pays for what
Device integration and mobile attendance	Ask the vendor to confirm your eSSL model and to quote the integration separately; list any monthly cost for maps or location services
Training and change management	Short videos, a few training sessions and an internal champion
Support and maintenance	Annual plan after warranty, with stated response times
Contingency	Keep a reserve of about 10% to 15% for changes that come from real use
Growth headroom	Ask the vendor for load-test results, the no-code growth drill and a running-cost estimate at 10, 100 and 1,000 users

How to judge whether it is paying back

- Owner hours per week freed from follow-ups, and what those hours now earn in design and business development
- Reduction in project delay days and in rework on site
- Faster collection of payments and fewer unpaid revisions
- Higher conversion of enquiries to projects
- Higher client ratings and more referrals

17. Adoption: Making the Team Enthusiastic

1. **Explain the why:** the message is "this protects your incentive and removes micromanagement", not "the owner is watching you".
2. **Co-design with the team:** let team leads help set the scorecards and templates so the rules feel fair.

- **Run the first planning day together:** the owner and leads spend half a day drafting the Studio Plan and the first quarter's Rocks, so the team sees where the studio is going and why the software asks what it asks.

3. **Start with a small pilot** of 5 to 6 people on 2 to 3 live projects. Let them become the champions.
4. **Shadow mode for incentives** for 2 months before any payout.
5. **Leaders go first:** you and the captains run every review from the dashboard, never from memory or WhatsApp.
6. **One source of truth:** if it is not in the system, it did not happen, for work and for incentives.
7. **Listen and fix:** after each sprint ask the pilot group what annoys them and what helps; fix the top three annoyances before adding anything.
8. **Celebrate small wins:** the weekly shout-out and the streak keep the mood positive.
9. **Name a system admin** inside the studio, so you are not dependent on the vendor for routine changes.

18. Risks and Mitigations

Risk	What we do about it
Team resists the change	Pilot, champions, co-designed rules, shadow mode, and leaders using the dashboard in every review
The software becomes complicated	The five lean tests, the guardrails in Appendix C, and a one-month rule: a feature used by fewer than half the pilot group is removed or redesigned
Scores feel unfair	Automatic data only, visible exclusion of external delays, adjustments logged, shadow mode first
Poor internet at sites	Site app works offline and syncs later (Phase 2); photos and voice notes queued
Vendor dependence	Own all code, accounts and data; documentation; handover training; exit clause
Scope creep during the build	Fixed scope per phase; every new idea must name its daily user and what it replaces
Data and client confidentiality	Role-based access, encryption, backups, audit log and written security practices
Staff feel watched because of location marking	Location only at punch, written notice and consent, limited access and storage, and an explanation that it protects site staff from being marked absent
Fake or wrong location punches	Server time, fake-location detection, site zones, selfie for remote punches, and an exceptions list for managers
eSSL machine does not connect as expected	Confirm model and method in Phase 0; fallback is scheduled file import; the machine is never replaced
Deduction rules cause disputes	Written policy acknowledged by staff, visible counters, warnings before deduction, logged waivers, and a check with your HR or legal adviser
Turnkey cost overrun or cash squeeze	Budget baseline by cost code, committed-cost alerts, project cash-flow forecast and weekly Project Pulse
Large turnkey projects run before controls are ready	Bring controls 2, 4 and 5 forward for those projects (Section 4)
Too many priorities, or the Scaling Up routines turn into extra meetings	At most 5 Rocks a quarter and 3 to 5 numbers per team; fixed meeting lengths; agendas generated by the software; any routine nobody uses for a quarter is dropped (Appendix C)

Risk	What we do about it
Everything gets marked Do first, so numbers lose meaning	Only leaders can use Do first, one at a time per person; the system shows each giver's Do first count to the owner monthly; Auto ranking is the default
Software is outgrown as the studio multiplies	Growth headroom requirements and the no-code growth drill in Section 14, load tests before each phase, open API, and full code ownership so any capable developer can extend it
Too many layers, or approvals slow the work	Flat by default: no more than 4 levels between owner and a junior; approvals by value bands so small items never wait; an approval pending over 1 working day alerts and escalates; deputies named for leave

19. Success Targets at 12 Months

Area	Target
Owner time	Under 30 minutes a day on follow-ups, with one 30-minute weekly review
Task discipline	90% or more of tasks completed on or before the date the person committed to
Projects on time	85% or more, compared with your current baseline
Client satisfaction	Average rating 95% or higher; every low score followed up within 24 hours
Performance system	100% of staff with an automatic monthly scorecard and incentive statement
Daily use	Over 90% of staff using My Day on most working days, in about 2 minutes a day
Enquiries	Every enquiry tracked with a first response inside 30 minutes during working hours
Capacity	Each project captain handling about twice as many projects as today, with quality maintained
Attendance	100% of staff attendance captured automatically; manual corrections under 5% of days; payroll attendance summary ready within one day of month-end
Turnkey control	Every Tier 2 and Tier 3 project with a weekly Project Pulse; cost variance and cash position visible weekly; forecast margin within an agreed range of plan
Strategy and rhythm	Every person can name this quarter's Rocks; at least 80% of Rocks completed on time; quarterly and annual planning held on the planned dates; weekly reviews run from the dashboard
Studio cash	Days to invoice, days to collect and the cash conversion cycle measured monthly and improving against your baseline; 13-week studio cash forecast reviewed weekly once built (Phase 4)
Task clarity	At least 90% of staff say in the weekly two-tap check that their priorities were clear; clashes resolved within 2 hours; Do first used on under 10% of tasks
Growth headroom	The no-code growth drill passed in every phase; pages under 2 seconds at the agreed load; adding a branch or service line takes days, not a new software project
Hierarchy and approvals	Every person has one line manager and every function an owner; all approvals routed by the matrix; no approval waits over 1 working day; org chart checked against reality each quarter

20. Your First 30 Days

1. List the 10 to 15 tasks you chase every day. These become the first automatic reminders.

2. Write one page for each stage in Section 3 describing how your studio really does it, and gather your existing templates: proposals, agreements, drawing checklists, BOQ formats and site checklists.
3. Draft the role scorecards and the incentive pool percentage, and discuss them with your team leads.
4. Define what "Red project" means for your studio: days late, budget overrun, client score.

- Hold a half-day planning session with your leads to draft the Studio Plan: core values, a 3 to 5 year target, the brand promise, annual priorities, the first quarter's 3 to 5 Rocks and one Critical Number. Note your current days to invoice and days to collect as the cash baseline.
- Draw your organisation as it is today: departments, who heads each, who reports to whom, who acts as deputy, and the value limits you are comfortable with for purchases, change orders and discounts.

5. Choose 5 to 6 pilot users from design, site, sales and accounts, and appoint one of them as the future system admin.
6. Send the development RFP to 2 to 3 shortlisted vendors, include the code ownership terms, and ask each to demonstrate a prototype to your staff.
7. Note the model number of your eSSL machine, how it is connected, and how you export logs today; list every employee with machine ID, shift and normal place of work.
8. Write down your attendance and leave policy exactly as you run it today (grace time, late marks, deductions, half-day and full-day hours, Sunday and holiday work), and list each site with its address so site zones can be set.
9. List your current and expected turnkey projects by type (civil, interior, renovation, commercial, factory), with the usual stages, contractors and approvals for each, and decide the size tiers in Section 4.
10. Decide your Phase 0 and Phase 1 budget cap and who in the studio makes decisions during the build.

Appendix A. Key User Stories for Phase 1

Each story has simple acceptance checks the vendor must meet.

Story	Acceptance checks
A1. As an employee, I see only today's most important tasks so I know what to do without being told.	At most 5 tasks shown, numbered 1 to 5 in priority order; each shows project, due date and why it ranks there; Done is one tap
A2. I can mark a task Blocked with a reason so my captain helps instead of chasing me.	Reason chosen from a short list; captain alerted within a minute; external reasons are excluded from my delay score
A3. I commit to my own dates each Monday.	Week plan card on My Day with "Looks good" or "Change a date"; captain approves changes over 2 days; promises kept is recorded
A4. I do a quick evening check-in.	Two taps (finished? blocked?) plus optional voice note; under 2 minutes
A5. I see who is waiting for my work.	Task shows the next person, their role and the date they need it
A6. As the owner or a team lead, I assign a task and choose its priority in three taps.	Required fields are what, who and due date; level chosen from Do first, Today, This week or Later (Auto if not chosen); preview shows the person's queue and the number the task will get; only leaders can choose Do first; peers can request but not set Do first.
A7. As an employee, I always see the order in which to do my tasks.	Numbers 1 to 5 on My Day with a short reason; a new Do first task becomes number 1 and the others shift automatically; a push asks me for one new date; the delay is tagged "priority change".

Story	Acceptance checks
A8. As an employee, I can flag a clash without having to decide it myself.	"Clash: help me choose" alerts both givers or the captain within a minute; decision logged within the agreed time (for example 2 hours); the queue updates; no blame for the delay.
A9. As a captain, I reorder my team's queue and see overload.	Drag to reorder on the Team board; each person's load shown; warning when a person has more than one Do first or more due today than a day allows (rule in Settings); each giver's Do first count visible to the owner monthly.
B1. As the owner, I want automatic reminders and escalation.	Morning list, deadline reminder, late prompt, then team lead, then owner; timings editable in Settings; at most 3 notifications a day per person
C1. As the owner, I want a home screen showing only what needs me.	Red projects with reason, blocked tasks, approvals, low scores; each item drills down; shows "All clear" if none
D1. As a salesperson, I want every enquiry in one pipeline.	Manual, website form and WhatsApp entry; owner and next-action date on each; amber alert after 24 hours without action
D2. I want to send a proposal quickly.	Pick template, enter area and rates, fee stages calculate; trackable link; know if it was opened
D3. A project is created automatically when a lead is won.	Short form; all tasks created with owners by role and dates; client welcome sent; first 7 days of tasks appear on My Day
E1. I see my score and how it is calculated.	Breakdown by metric, 6-month trend, would-be incentive labelled "shadow mode, not paid"
E3. As admin, I change scorecard weights without a developer.	Edited in Settings; every change logged with date and name
F1. I choose a colour theme.	Light, Dark and 3 palettes with live preview; saved to my profile
G1. As a client, I see my project's progress without calling.	Progress, stage, next decision, documents; one-tap approve or request change, time-stamped; one-tap rating at three points
H1. As a site engineer, I can mark attendance from the site without visiting the office.	Punch In and Out in one tap; time from the server; location and accuracy recorded; inside the site zone is verified automatically
H2. As a manager, I see where my team is today.	Board shows Office, Site (name), Leave or Not yet punched; outside-zone punches need my approval with a reason
H3. As an employee, I can fix a missed punch.	Correction request within the set window with reason and proof; manager approves; counted in the HR exceptions
H4. As HR, the late-mark rule is applied automatically.	Grace time, limit and deduction set in Settings; counter visible to the employee; waivers logged; month-end summary exports to payroll
H5. The eSSL machine punches appear in the software.	Imported automatically or by scheduled file; matched by employee ID; duplicates merged
P1. As an employee, I apply for leave in three taps.	Balance visible; manager approves in one tap; team calendar updated; warning on clash with a critical milestone
T1. As a project manager, I choose the project type and tier when I create a project.	The matching template and controls appear; staff screens stay simple
T2. As a project manager, I see budget, committed and actual cost by package.	Alert when commitments pass a package budget; purchase orders need approval by value
T3. As a store keeper, I record material in and out in a few taps.	Delivery photo, quantity and issue to work; stock balance and low-stock alert

Story	Acceptance checks
T4. As the owner, I get a weekly Project Pulse for each large project.	One page: progress, cost, cash, risks, decisions, safety; ready before the weekly review
S1. As the owner, I keep one Studio Plan page and update it each quarter.	Core values, 3 to 5 year target, brand promise, annual priorities, quarterly Rocks and Critical Number on one screen; only the Owner edits; every change logged with date and version; everyone can view.
S2. As an employee, I see which Rock my task supports.	Task shows a small Rock label where relevant; at most 5 Rocks per quarter; Rock progress rolls up from linked tasks; no extra data entry.
S3. As the owner, I get a Digital Huddle and a ready Weekly Review agenda.	Morning message with wins, top priorities, blocked items and one number; agenda generated with Critical Number, Rocks, red projects, client and staff voice; huddle frequency set per team (Off, 2 days a week, Daily); counts within 3 notifications a day.
S4. As the owner, I see who owns each function and process.	Function chart with owner, backup and 3 to 5 weekly numbers pulled from the system; unowned functions flagged; each template shows a process owner; staff can tap 'slow or unclear' on a step and it reaches the process owner.
S5. As the owner, I see the studio's cash health on one tile (Phase 3).	Days to invoice, days to collect, days to pay vendors, unbilled work and cash conversion cycle by month; drills down to the project; no manual entry beyond billing and payments already recorded.
O1. As an admin, I set up departments, reporting lines and deputies in Settings.	Org tree with unlimited depth; every person has exactly one line manager and one department; changes logged; org chart view in People; no developer needed.
O2. As the owner, I set approval limits and the system routes approvals.	Value bands for purchase orders, change orders, discounts and payments; approval goes to the named deputy if the approver is on leave; alert and escalation after 1 working day (editable).
O3. As a department head, I see my department on one screen.	Scoreboard numbers, Rocks owned, workload and clashes, approvals waiting, department projects by colour; no other department's private data.
O4. As an employee with two bosses, I know who decides what.	Line manager handles leave, attendance corrections and appraisal; Project Captain sets tasks and priority within the project; clashes go to the Clash button and up the ladder.

Appendix B. Core Data the Software Holds

Object	Key fields
User	Name, role, phone, team, theme, language
Lead	Source, contact, budget, project type, stage, owner, next-action date, lost reason
Proposal	Lead, template, fee stages, status, opened or not
Project	Client, type, area, start and end dates, captain, health colour, status
Task	Project, title, why it matters, owner, committed date, status, blocked reason, depends on, critical or not, priority level, priority number, set by, reason for rank, pushed by and when
Template	Project type, stages, tasks, durations, owner by role, dependencies, quality gates

Object	Key fields
Drawing	Project, title, discipline, revision number, status, file, approved by and when
Site question / Snag	Project, drawing or location, photo, raised by, assigned to, due date, status
Commitment and Check-in	User, week or day, tasks, committed date, kept or not, blocked
Approval	Project, item, requested from, status, time-stamp
Rating	Project, rating point, score, comment
Score	User, month, metric values, total, would-be incentive
Rule	Type (reminder, escalation, weights, thresholds, gates, attendance), values, changed by, changed on
Employee	Job details, manager, shift, normal place of work, documents, machine ID, items issued
Punch and Attendance day	Source (machine, phone, correction), time, location and accuracy, site or place, status, late mark, approved by
Site zone	Project, address, centre point, radius, site shift start
Leave	Type, dates, balance, approver, status
Budget line	Project, cost code, budget, committed, actual, forecast to complete
Purchase order and Work order	Vendor or contractor, package, quantity, rate, approval, status, running bills, retention
Stock movement	Project, material, in or out, quantity, challan photo, issued to
Safety, quality or statutory item	Project, type, date, status, owner, evidence
Studio Plan and Rock	Plan: core values, purpose, 3 to 5 year target, brand promise, annual priorities, version. Rock: quarter, title, owner, linked tasks, progress, status
Scoreboard number, Function and Process owner	Team or function or process, measure, weekly value, target, owner, backup
Pulse response and Recommend score	Person (hidden in summaries), quarter, start, stop, keep; client, project, 0 to 10 score, point in time
Cash snapshot	Month, days to invoice, days to collect, days to pay vendors, unbilled work, advance held against cost committed
Department and Position	Department, level, head, line manager, deputy, branch, functions owned, scoreboard numbers
Approval limit	Decision type, role, value band, deputy, escalation time

Appendix C. Lean Guardrails Checklist

Give this page to every vendor, manager and team lead. Use it at the end of every sprint.

1. Every new feature names its daily user and what it replaces. If it replaces nothing, it waits.
2. Nobody enters the same data twice.
3. No form has more than 5 required fields. Everything else is optional or pre-filled.
4. Phone first: a screen is designed for a phone before a laptop.
5. Staff screens never show reports. Charts and analysis belong to the owner and managers.
6. Settings are hidden from normal users. Only the Admin sees rules, templates and weights.

7. Labels use your studio's own words (for example Release for Site, Snag, RA bill).
8. At most 3 notifications per person per day.
9. A feature used by fewer than half the pilot users in a month is reviewed and removed or redesigned.
10. After every sprint ask the team what annoys them, and fix the top three before adding anything new.
11. Switch on only what the project type and size need: a small interior project never sees factory controls.

- Every Scaling Up routine fits on one page or one screen and has a fixed time limit. If it needs more, simplify it.
- At most 5 Rocks per quarter and 3 to 5 numbers per team. Values are discussed, never scored.
- Every task has a priority number. One Do first at a time per person. Leaders set the order, people set the dates.
- No more than 4 levels between the owner and a junior. Every person has exactly one line manager, and every function has one owner.

12. Location is captured only when a person punches or checks in, never continuously.
13. Better to ship 10 things that work beautifully than 30 that confuse.

Appendix D. Attendance Policy: Starting Settings

These are the settings the Admin can change at any time. Values in brackets are examples for you to confirm.

Setting	Starting value
Office shift start and end	[Your office timing]
Site shift start	[Your site timing, may differ by project]
Grace period	10 minutes
Late marks before a deduction	3 in a calendar month
Deduction for reaching the limit	Half a day's salary
Full-day and half-day hours	[for example 8 hours and 4 hours]
Waiver of a late mark	By the manager, with a reason, logged
Correction request window	[for example 48 hours]
Site zone radius	[for example 100 to 200 metres], adjustable per site
Offline punch	Allowed, flagged for confirmation
Work from home	[days per month, if allowed], with approval
Sunday and holiday work	Comp-off or overtime, with approval
Location and selfie retention	[for example 12 months]
Leave types and yearly credits	[as per your leave policy]

Related document: the vendor RFP (prepared separately) carries these rules, the code ownership clauses, the timeline and the payment milestones, so it can be shared with development partners without sharing this internal plan. It is to be updated with the HR, attendance, turnkey and Scaling Up requirements in this version.